

Project Charter: Annual Innovation Day

Prepared for: Innovate Inc. — HR Department

Problem Statement

Recent employee feedback surveys reveal a decline in cross-departmental collaboration and creative thinking at Innovate Inc. Without a structured outlet for employees to work across teams and innovate, the company risks losing engagement and falling behind on solving key business challenges.

Project Objectives

- Launch Innovate Inc.'s first-ever "Annual Innovation Day" within three months.
- Increase cross-departmental collaboration by giving employees a full day to form mixed teams and brainstorm solutions to business challenges.
- Provide a formal forum for employees to present innovative ideas to a panel of executives.

Key Stakeholders

- Head of HR - project sponsor and primary requester.
- Junior Project Manager (author) - responsible for planning and executing the event.
- Executive Panel - evaluates team presentations and must approve the project and budget.
- All Employees - participants who form teams and take part in the event.

Scope

In-Scope:

- Organizing team formation, brainstorming sessions, and the final presentation event within the three-month timeline.
- Coordinating the executive judging panel and defining presentation logistics, within HR's limited budget.

Out-of-Scope:

- Implementation or funding of the winning ideas after Innovation Day concludes.
- Establishing Innovation Day as a recurring annual event beyond this first installment.

Success Criteria

- At least 80% of employees participate by forming or joining a team.
- The event is delivered on schedule (within three months) and within the allocated HR budget.

Reflection: The Success Criteria section is the most critical for gaining executive approval, since it turns a vague goal into measurable proof of value that justifies the budget and effort.